

NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd.

Leave Policy

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1. Purpose

NovaTech Solutions recognizes that planned time away from work is essential for employee well-being, productivity, and work-life balance.

This policy defines the eligibility criteria, leave types, approval procedures, carry-forward rules, and responsibilities associated with employee leave.

Employees should also refer to the **Employee Handbook (HR-EMP-001)** for general employment policies.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- Full-time employees
- Probationary employees
- Confirmed employees

The policy does not apply to:

- Interns
- Temporary workers
- Third-party contractors
- Consultants

Separate contractual agreements govern leave entitlements for these categories.

3. Leave Categories

NovaTech provides the following leave categories:

Leave Type	Annual Entitlement
Annual Paid Leave	24 days
Casual Leave	8 days
Sick Leave	12 days
Maternity Leave	26 weeks
Paternity Leave	10 working days
Bereavement Leave	5 working days
Leave Without Pay	As approved

4. Annual Paid Leave

All confirmed full-time employees receive **24 days of Annual Paid Leave (APL)** every calendar year.

Eligibility

Employees become eligible after successful confirmation of employment.

During the probation period, Annual Paid Leave accrues proportionately but may only be used with manager approval.

Rules

- Leave should be planned in advance.
 - A maximum of **15 consecutive working days** may be taken without additional HR approval.
 - Employees should maintain sufficient leave balance before submitting requests.
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5. Casual Leave

Casual Leave is intended for short personal commitments or unforeseen circumstances.

Employees receive **8 Casual Leave days** per calendar year.

Rules

- Normally limited to **2 consecutive working days**.
- Cannot be combined with Annual Paid Leave without manager approval.
- Unused Casual Leave expires at the end of the calendar year.

Casual Leave cannot be encashed.

6. Sick Leave

Employees receive **12 Sick Leave days** annually.

Sick Leave is intended for illness, medical treatment, or recovery.

Medical Certificate

A medical certificate is mandatory when:

- Sick Leave exceeds **3 consecutive working days**.
- Requested by Human Resources.

Employees should notify their reporting manager before the start of the working day whenever reasonably possible.

Unused Sick Leave cannot be encashed or carried forward.

7. Maternity Leave

Eligible female employees are entitled to **26 weeks of paid maternity leave** in accordance with applicable employment laws.

Eligibility requires:

- Completion of the probation period.
- Submission of supporting medical documentation.

Employees should notify Human Resources at least **8 weeks before** the expected start date whenever possible.

8. Paternity Leave

Eligible employees are entitled to **10 working days** of paid paternity leave.

The leave must normally be used within **90 days** of the child's birth or legal adoption.

Unused paternity leave expires after the eligibility period.

9. Bereavement Leave

Employees may receive **up to 5 working days** of paid bereavement leave following the death of an immediate family member.

Immediate family includes:

- Spouse
- Parent
- Child
- Sibling

Additional unpaid leave may be approved in exceptional circumstances.

10. Leave Without Pay (LWP)

Leave Without Pay may be approved when:

- Paid leave balances are exhausted.
- Exceptional personal circumstances exist.
- Business requirements permit extended absence.

Approval requires:

1. Reporting Manager

2. Department Head
3. Human Resources

LWP does not accrue Annual Paid Leave during the unpaid period.

11. Public Holidays

NovaTech observes the public holidays announced annually by Human Resources.

The holiday calendar is published every December for the following calendar year.

Employees required to work on public holidays may receive:

- A compensatory day off, or
 - Additional compensation, depending on business requirements.
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12. Leave Application Process

Employees should submit leave requests through the **Employee Self-Service (ESS) Portal**.

Approval Workflow

1. Employee submits request.
2. Reporting Manager reviews availability and workload.
3. HR verifies leave balance.
4. Final approval is communicated through the ESS Portal.

Recommended notice periods:

Leave Duration	Notice Period
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1 day	1 working day
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2–5 days	5 working days
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More than 5 days	10 working days
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Emergency leave requests should be communicated to the reporting manager as soon as reasonably possible.

13. Leave Cancellation

Employees may cancel approved leave before the scheduled start date through the ESS Portal.

Manager approval is required if cancellation affects project planning or resource allocation.

14. Carry Forward Policy

Employees may carry forward a maximum of **10 unused Annual Paid Leave days** into the next calendar year.

Carried-forward leave must be used by **30 June** of the following year.

Unused carried-forward leave automatically expires after this date.

Casual Leave and Sick Leave cannot be carried forward.

15. Leave Encashment

Annual Paid Leave may be encashed only:

- At separation from employment, or
- When specifically approved by Human Resources under company policy.

Maximum encashment is limited to **30 accumulated Annual Paid Leave days**.

Casual Leave and Sick Leave are not eligible for encashment.

16. Misuse of Leave

The company reserves the right to investigate suspected misuse of leave.

Examples include:

- Submission of fraudulent medical certificates.
- Repeated unauthorized absences.
- Providing false information during leave requests.
- Engaging in employment with another organization while on approved medical leave without prior authorization.

Confirmed misuse may result in disciplinary action, including termination of employment.

17. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How many Annual Paid Leave days do I receive?

Confirmed employees receive **24 Annual Paid Leave days** each calendar year.

Q: Can I carry forward my unused leave?

Yes. A maximum of **10 Annual Paid Leave days** may be carried forward until **30 June** of the following year.

Q: Can Sick Leave be carried forward?

No.

Unused Sick Leave expires at the end of the calendar year.

Q: Is a medical certificate always required?

No.

A medical certificate is generally required only when Sick Leave exceeds **3 consecutive working days** or when requested by Human Resources.

Q: Can Casual Leave be encashed?

No.

Only Annual Paid Leave may be eligible for encashment under specific conditions.

Q: What happens if I have no leave balance remaining?

Employees may apply for **Leave Without Pay**, subject to managerial and Human Resources approval.

Revision History

Version	Date	Description
1.0	January 2024	Initial Release
1.5	January 2025	Added Paternity Leave
2.0	July 2025	Updated Carry Forward Rules
2.1	January 2026	Clarified Leave Encashment and FAQ